Live it, think about it, revise it if necessary. Players improve themselves as people, coaches become better teachers; everyone benefits.

Peter acknowledged he pushed too hard in his first stint with England and took too much on himself. We worked collaboratively, to enable players to discover where they were, and what they needed to do, either technically or personally, to progress. I was disappointed he only lasted little more than a year, but coaching is an unforgiving business. The best cricket coaches, like the best football managers, rarely have long cycles in charge. There is a huge burnout factor; travel is constant and pressure rarely relents.

Looking at senior players on the verge of making the transition today, I can see Marcus Trescothick and Ian Bell being successful coaches. They are both low-key characters, hugely experienced players, bonded by a deep love of cricket. Their lives are based on the game, and they have a deceptively fierce drive. They don't hang around to admire the view; they want to climb upwards, safely and effectively. They have the level-headedness to appreciate that the art of coaching is incredibly hard.

Ultimately, success or failure is down to the player. You can't always hold his hand, though there will be times when you are forced to do so. He must make his mistakes, put his fingers in the fire and get burned. Graham Gooch, in his old-school way, understood the power of pain. Whenever I made an error in my batting, he expected me to learn from it.

The tenor of coaching is changing, in all sports. Back in the day, the 'tell me' coach held sway. Now it is fashionable for the player to be asked to find the solution. Theoretically that makes sense, because he is in the middle thinking for himself, looking for the answer, but I wonder whether the pendulum has swung too far.

Sometimes you just need to be told. The player may insist on personal preferences, but if he is wrong, he must be challenged. It is a balance; the coach has to be strong but could cause damage if he is misguided. We're back to that common currency, trust. Does the coach have the eye of a batsman, for instance? It obviously helps if he has experience at the highest level.

Even though we decided we needed a new voice in his area of expertise, Goochy spoke with the authority of a fantastic Test career. He held the view that cricket is a game that cannot be tamed, though its contrasts and contradictions can be tolerable. Elementary mistakes can be minimized,